completing his service. I remembered that in the late 1970s he would sometimes appear at the entrance of the Hadar Dafna building, accept an envelope from the doorman, thank him, and leave. This was the way in which Ya'akov, who had already then cultivated a journalistic career as a security affairs commentator in the newspaper *Yedioth Ahronoth*, began receiving open-source intelligence on the Middle East from Hatzav— an OSINT unit. It was a sort of internal arrangement with an old colleague, one that was harmless but useful to a journalist.

Back to our meeting—Ya'akov wanted to talk to me about his book. As someone who for many years had been entrusted with the carrying out of clandestine activity and the keeping of secrets, he had been struggling with the question of whether he had the right to write his memoirs and publish them as a book. He described these dilemmas in detail, tackling the problem from both professional and moral perspectives. Professionally, does the statute of limitations justify the publication of information that belongs to the state? And morally, are people at the top of the hierarchy entitled to rights not granted to regular employees?

These deliberations, Ya'akov told me, caused him much agony, which increased with his illness. In the end, he decided to write the book. He felt, he said, that he owed it to his family, who had stuck by him and supported him throughout his years in the service. I could discern a tone of urgency in his words, as if he sensed that his time was running out. I could not then, as I cannot now, keep myself from thinking about the words he did not say, the things that could only be read between the lines. Ya'akov had served a giant, Isser Harel, and had become his deputy; he had then served another great man in the same position, Meir Amit, albeit for a short period of time. These two idols' lives were commemorated by the state, the people, and themselves. Ya'akov's place as a "number two" in the heroic narrative of the establishment of the state and its security institutions remains unknown. If I am wrong in my interpretation of that meeting with him, I plead his forgiveness.

Since my personal acquaintance with Ya'akov, may his memory be blessed, did not go beyond that one meeting, I cannot elaborate any more than what I have said so far; I thought it might be appropriate to say a few things about the relationship that exists between the two professions Ya'akov chose over the course of his life—that of intelligence and security and that of journalism and media.